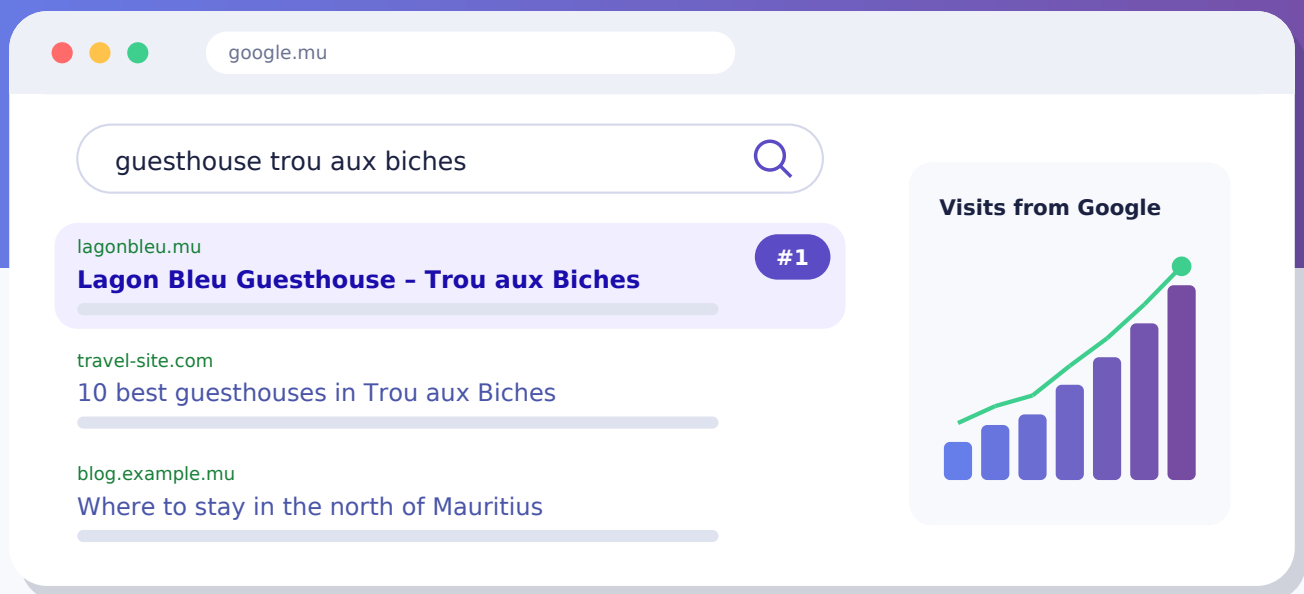


The Complete SEO Guide

SEO, AEO and GEO for beginners,
with real examples from Mauritius

Avinesh Bundhoo & Fareez Fawdar · Oreegami Mauritius · October 2026



Inside this guide

- 1 What SEO is and how Google works
- 2 Reading a Google results page
- 3 Keyword research
- 4 On-page SEO
- 5 Content strategy
- 6 Technical SEO
- 7 Google Search Console, step by step
- 8 Local SEO and Google Business Profile
- 9 Off-page SEO: reviews, links, reputation
- 10 AEO: Answer Engine Optimisation
- 11 GEO: Generative Engine Optimisation
- 12 Playbooks by type of business
- 13 Measuring and reporting
- 14 Updates, penalties and myths
- 15 Checklists and glossary
- 16 Homework: your SEO Action Plan

PART A

Foundations

What SEO is, how Google works,
and how to read a results page

SECTION 1

What SEO is and how Google works

SEO (Search Engine Optimisation) means making your website and your business easy for search engines to **find**, **understand** and **trust**, so you appear when people search for what you offer. The clicks you get from these "organic" results are free: you don't pay Google per visit, unlike Google Ads.

Why SEO matters for a Mauritian business

- **People search before they buy.** A tourist looking for a car, a family looking for a cake, a company looking for an accountant: most start on Google or Google Maps, usually on a phone.
- **It's free traffic that lasts.** A page that ranks well can bring visitors every day for years.
- **It builds trust.** Being at the top with good reviews tells people you are a real, serious business.
- **It now feeds AI.** Google AI Overviews, AI Mode, ChatGPT and Gemini build their answers from web pages, listings and reviews. Good SEO is the base for appearing there too (Part E).

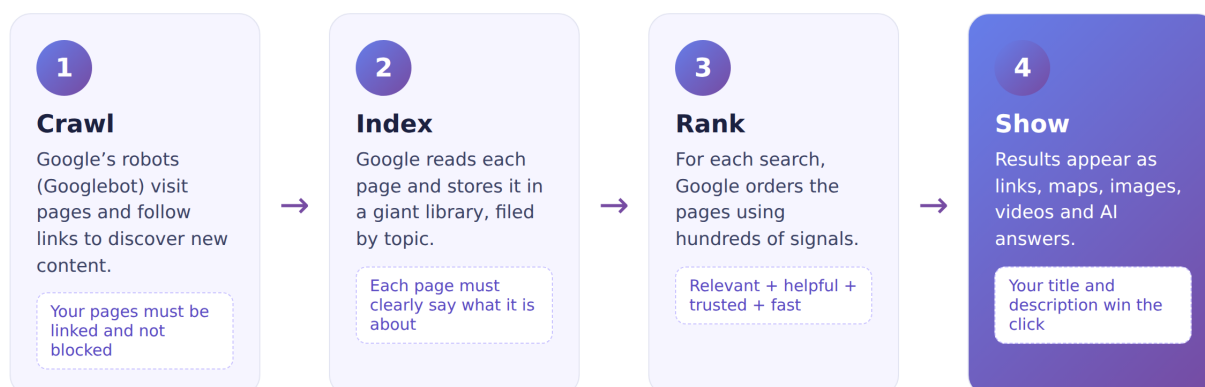
SEO vs Google Ads

	Google Ads (paid)	SEO (organic)
Cost per click	You pay for every click	Free (you invest time or an agency)
Speed	Visible the same day	Weeks to months
When you stop	You disappear immediately	Results keep working
Trust	Marked "Sponsored": some people skip ads	Often seen as more credible
Best for	Quick campaigns, offers, testing keywords	Long-term, steady, low-cost visitors

The two work best together: Ads bring visitors while SEO is building up, and Ads data shows which keywords convert. Google Ads is covered in Weeks 6 and 7.

How Google works in 4 steps

From your web page to the top of the results



Google works like a giant library: robots collect the pages, Google files them, then picks the best ones for each search.

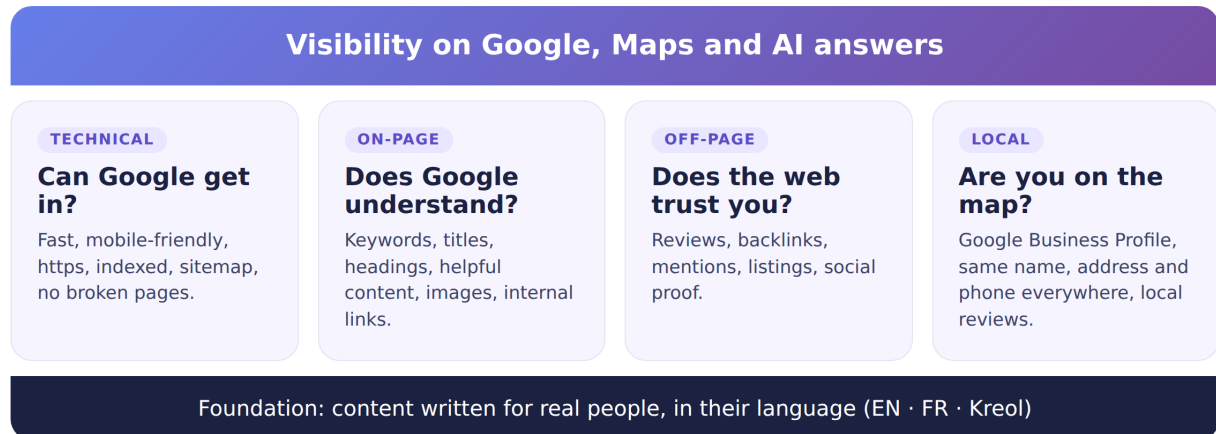
Try it now: type **site:yourwebsite.mu** into Google. The results are the pages Google has indexed. If nothing appears, Google has not found the site yet (see Section 7).

The questions Google asks about every page

- **Is it relevant?** Does the page match the words and the intention of the search?
- **Is it helpful?** Original, complete, accurate information written for people, not copied text.
- **Is it trusted?** Who is behind it? Do reviews, links and mentions on other sites confirm it?
- **Is it easy to use?** Fast, secure and clear on a mobile phone, even on mobile data.
- **Is it local?** For many searches, Google favours businesses close to the searcher.

The pillars of SEO

Strong rankings need all of them working together



Every part of this guide fits into one of these pillars.

Search engines and AI tools used in Mauritius

Tool	What it is	Why it matters
Google Search (google.mu)	By far the main search engine	Main focus of SEO
Google Maps	Local search and directions	Restaurants, shops, services, tourism
Google AI Overviews / AI Mode	AI answers inside Google	Can answer without a click (Part E)
Bing	Microsoft's search engine	Feeds Copilot and is one of the sources behind ChatGPT search
ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Copilot	AI assistants	People ask them for recommendations
YouTube, Facebook, TikTok, Instagram	Social platforms with their own search	Widely used locally; your pages there can rank on Google too

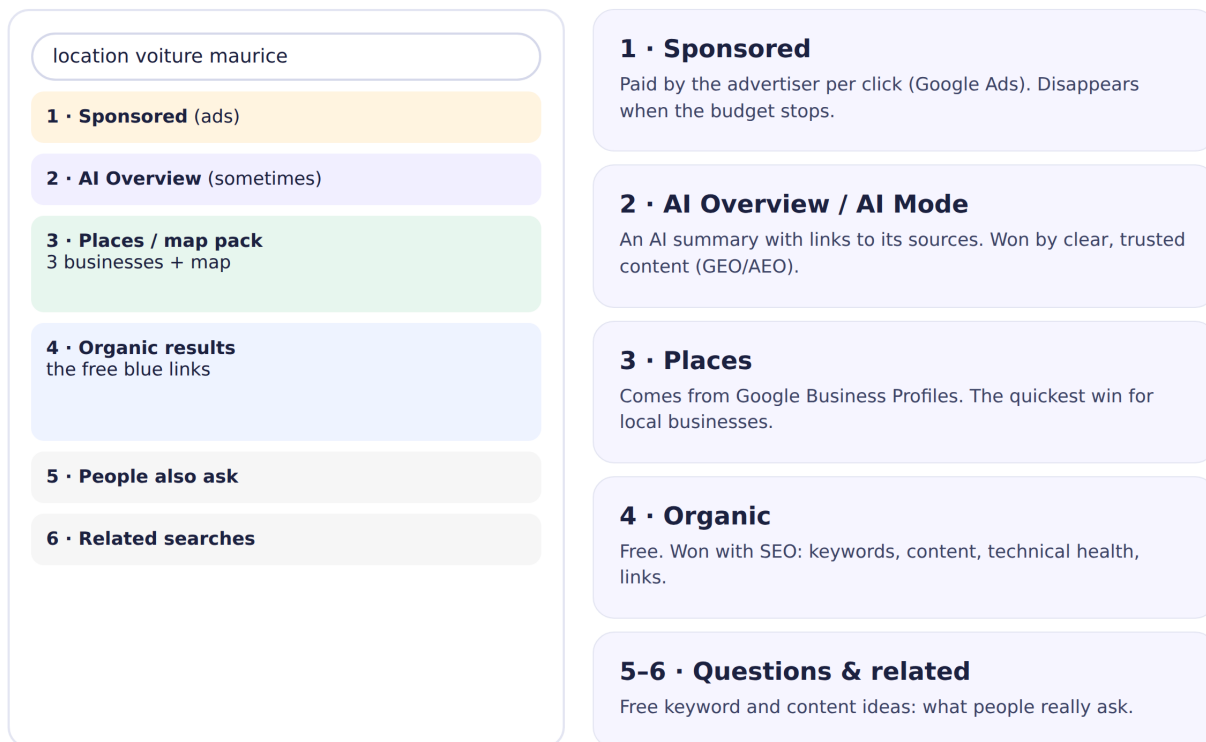
SECTION 2

Reading a Google results page

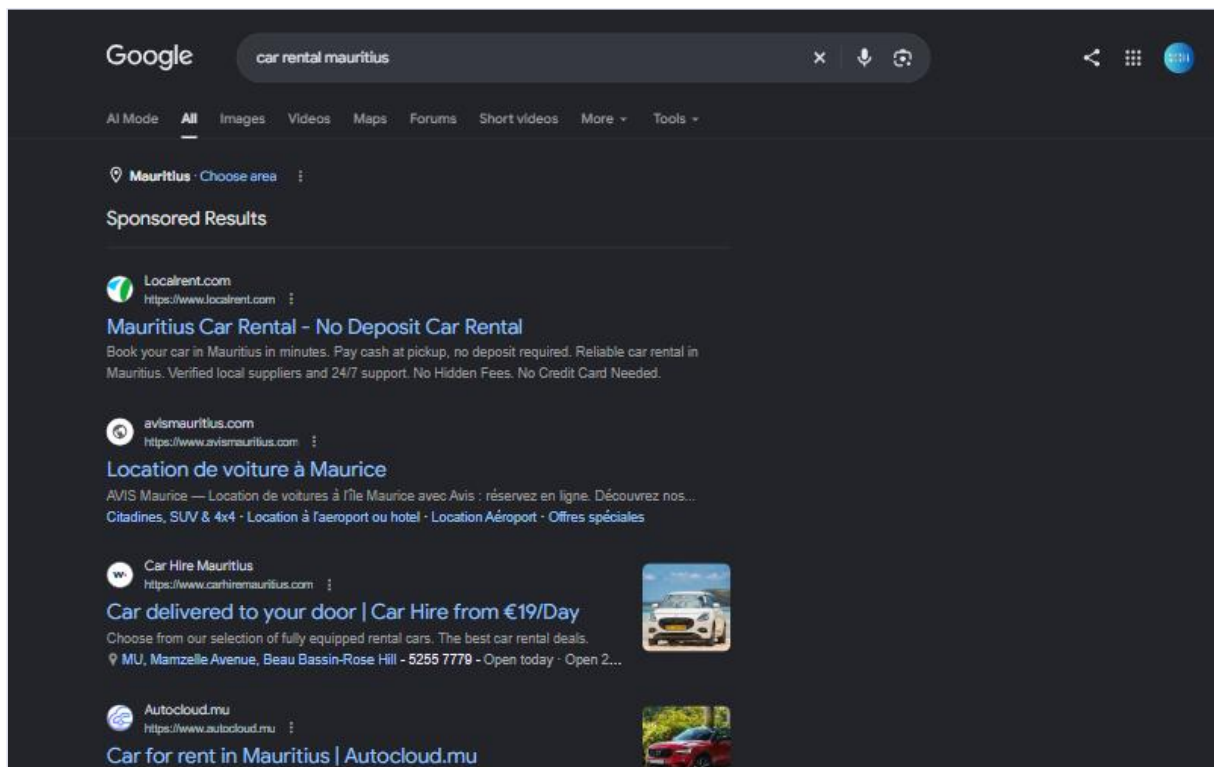
A results page (called a **SERP**, Search Engine Results Page) has several parts. Knowing them helps you decide where your business can realistically appear, and which tool gets you there.

The parts of a Google results page

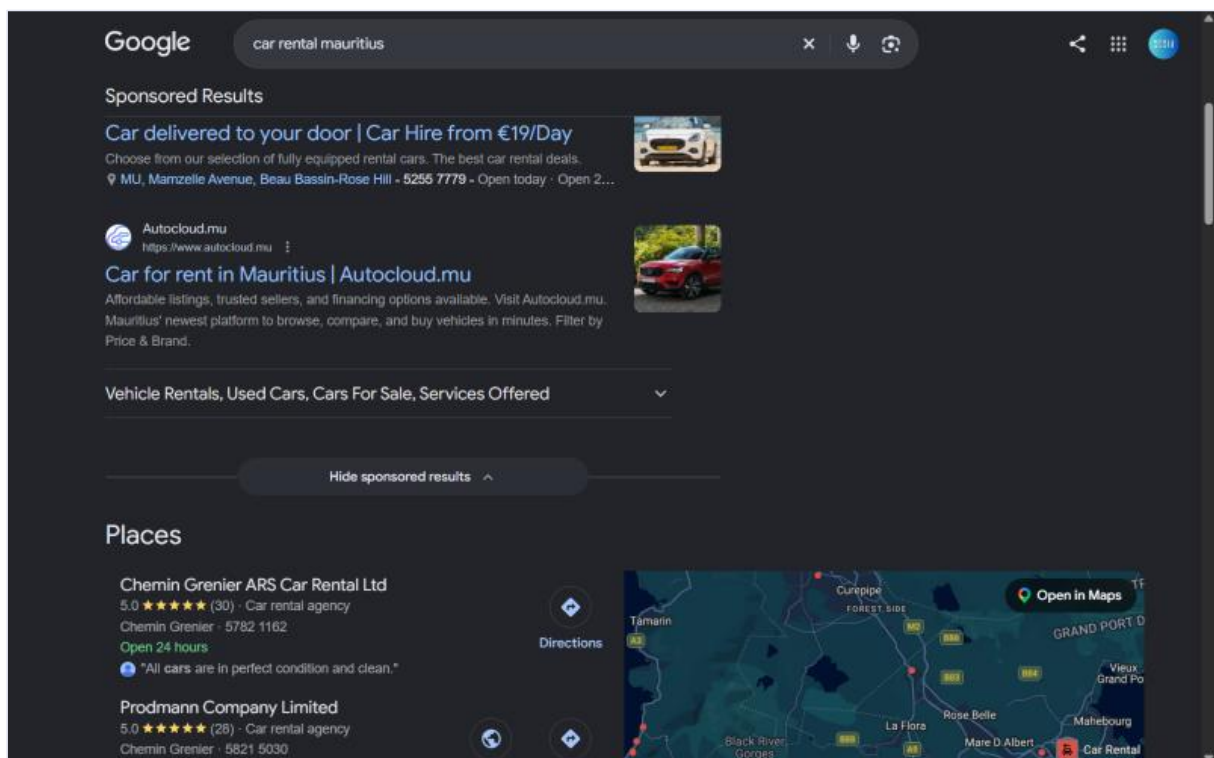
From top to bottom, on a typical local search in Mauritius



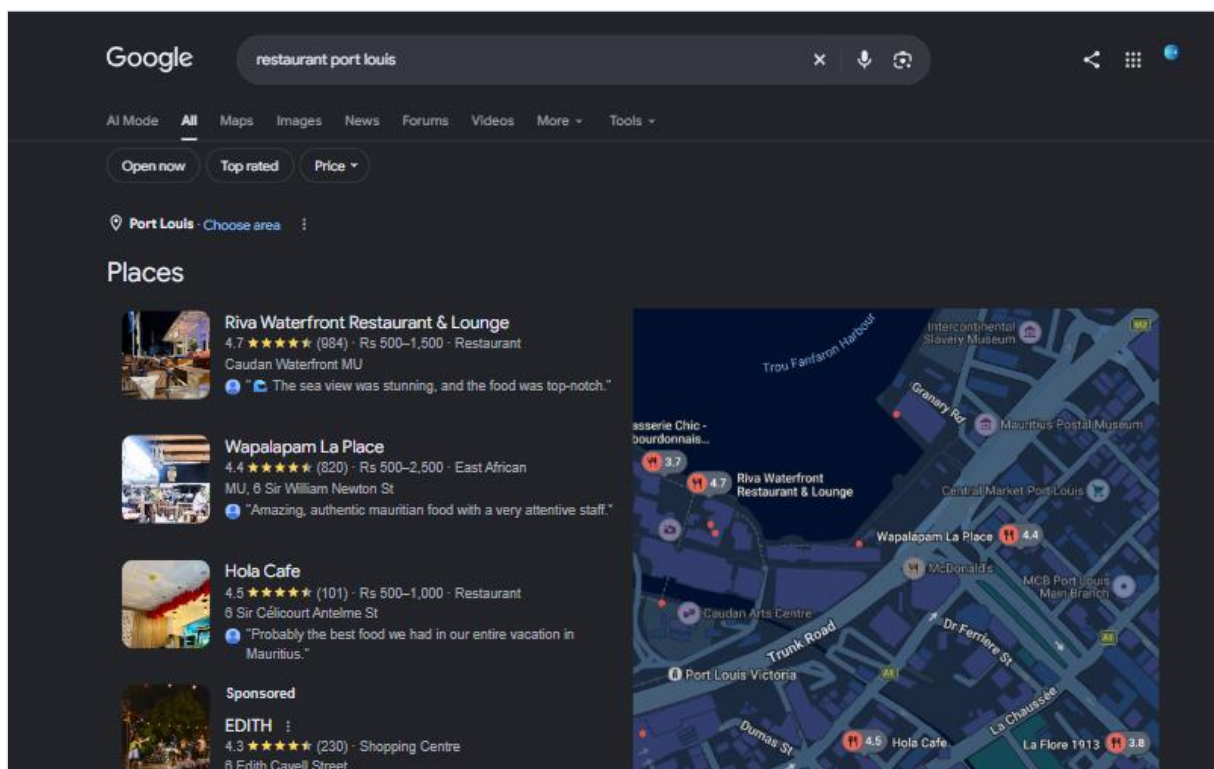
The order and the parts change with each search: Google shows what it thinks best answers the intent.



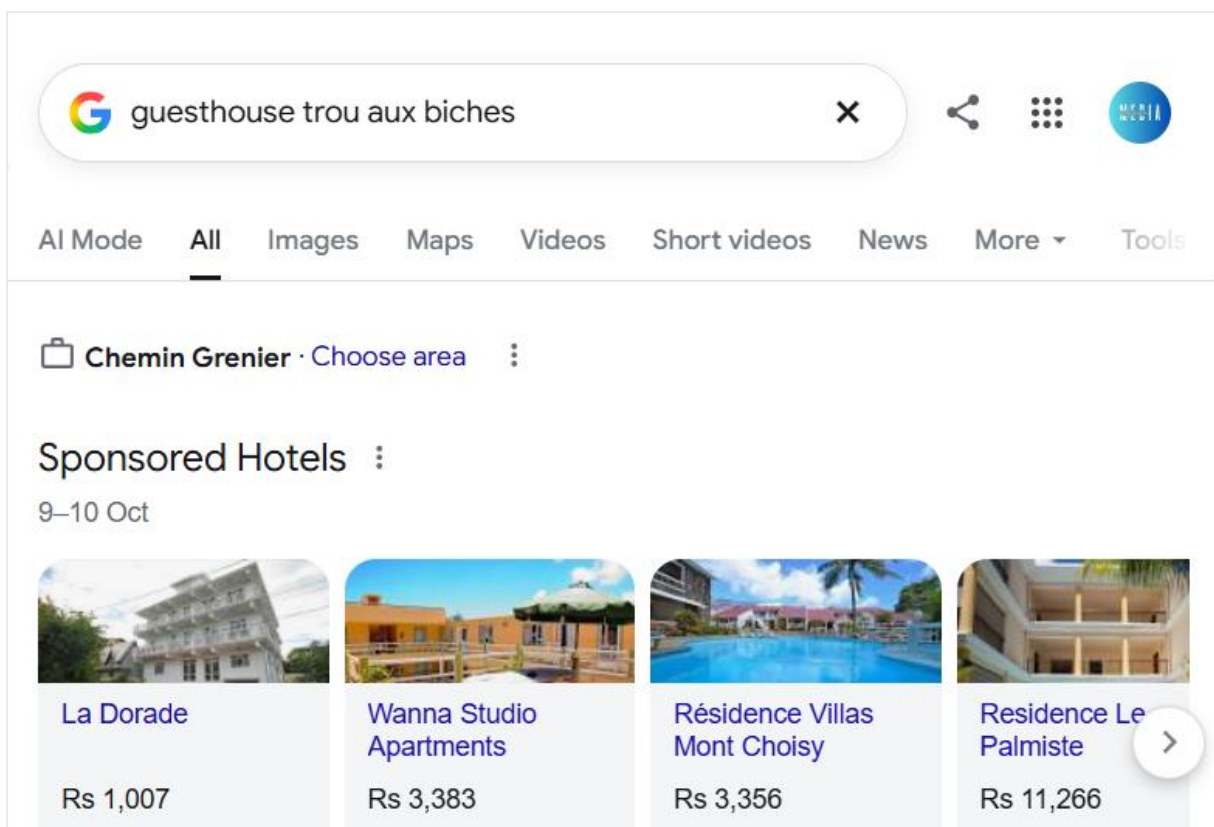
Search "car rental mauritius". The whole first screen is **Sponsored Results** (ads) from Localrent, Avis Mauritius, Car Hire Mauritius and Autocloud. Note the French ad title from avismauritius.com for an English search.



Same search, scrolling down: after the ads come the **Places** (map pack). The first two places are small agencies in Chemin Grenier with 30 and 28 reviews, because the searcher was located near Chemin Grenier. This is the **distance** factor of local SEO (Section 8).



Search "restaurant port louis": no ads at the top, Google goes straight to **Places** with ratings, number of reviews, price range and a review quote. Filters such as "Open now" and "Top rated" show what people care about. Riva Waterfront (4.7★, 984 reviews) and Wapalapam La Place (4.4★, 820 reviews) lead.



Search "guesthouse trou aux biches": sponsored hotel results with prices in rupees come first. Further down, the free results are dominated by Booking.com, Tripadvisor and Agoda. Note the **AI Mode** tab next to "All".

What these searches teach us

- **Every search looks different.** Commercial searches (car rental) are full of ads; local searches (restaurant) start with the map; informational searches (Section 10) start with an AI Overview.

- **Big platforms win broad searches.** A small guesthouse won't beat Booking.com on "guesthouse trou aux biches". It can win on Google Maps, on more specific searches, and by being well reviewed on those platforms.
- **Location changes everything.** The same search from Port Louis and from Chemin Grenier gives different Places.
- **Reviews are visible everywhere:** stars, number of reviews and quotes appear right in the results.

Exercise (10 min): search your main keyword on google.mu, on your phone and computer. Note: are there ads? A map? An AI Overview? Who are the top 3 organic results? Which part could your business realistically win?

PART B

Keywords & content

Find what your customers type,
then write pages that answer it

SECTION 3

Keyword research

A **keyword** is the word or phrase people type (or say) into a search engine. Keyword research means finding the words your customers really use, so you can create pages that match them. Businesses often describe themselves with fancy words; customers type simple ones.

What the business writes	What the customer types
"Boutique coastal accommodation"	guesthouse trou aux biches
"Premium vehicle hire solutions"	location voiture maurice pas cher
"Authentic street-food concept"	dholl puri near me
"Bespoke celebration patisserie"	birthday cake mauritius
"Holistic fitness destination"	ladies gym quatre bornes

Search intent: why is the person searching?

Match the page to the intent, not just the words

KNOW
Learn something
best time to visit mauritius
how to register a business in mauritius
Best page: guide, blog article, FAQ

GO
Reach a specific site
mcb internet banking
wapalapam la place
Best page: home page, brand page

LOCAL
Find a place nearby
dholl puri near me
gym quatre bornes
Best page: Google Business Profile + location page

DO / BUY
Act now
location voiture maurice pas cher
wedding cake mauritius delivery
Best page: service, product or booking page

The same topic can have different intents. Always ask: what does the person want to do next?

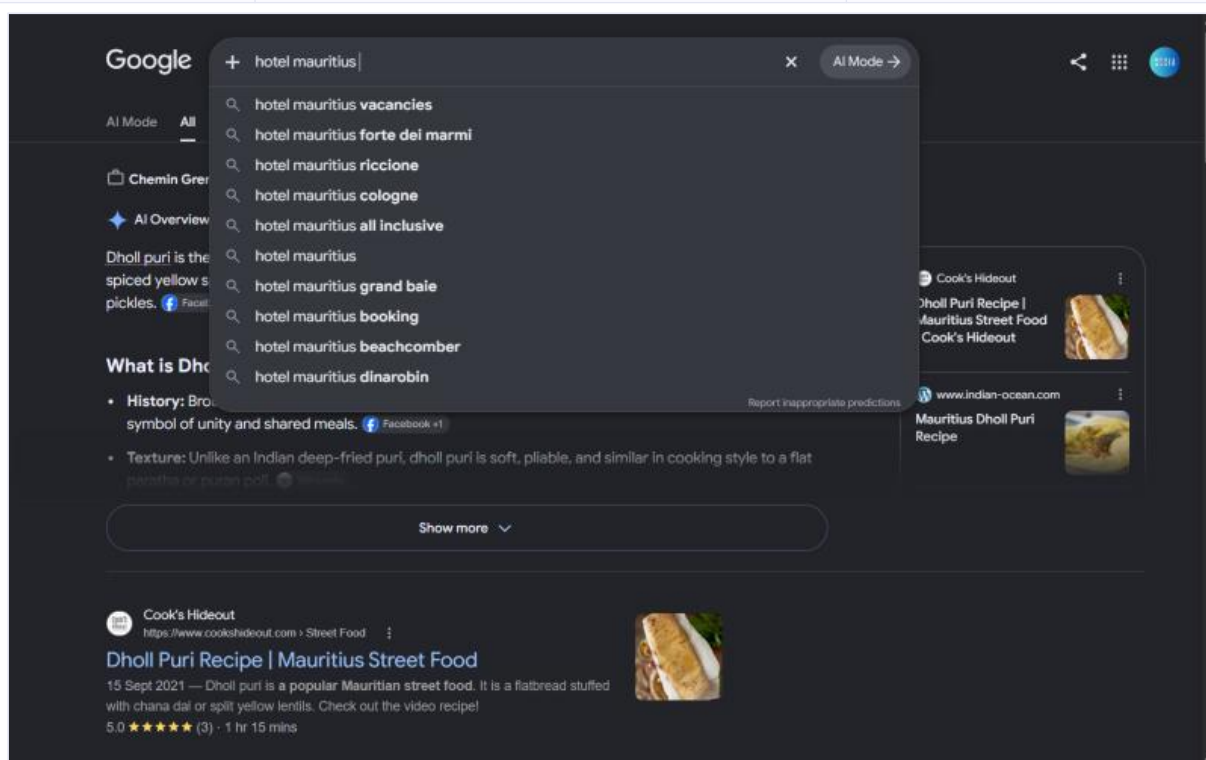
"Local" and "Do/Buy" searches are the most valuable for a small business: the person is ready to act. "Know" searches build awareness and are where AI answers appear most often.

What Mauritians really type: autocomplete

Google autocomplete shows what people often search. Here are suggestions from google.mu:

Start of the search	Suggestions from google.mu	What it tells us
restaurant grand baie	...pas cher · ...halal · ...chinese · ...bord de mer · ...la croisette · ...super u	Price, diet, cuisine and view matter; people mix French and English
location voiture maurice	...aéroport · ...pas cher · ...sans caution · ...grand baie · ...flic en flac · ...avis	Airport pick-up, price and deposit are the real questions
gym quatre bornes	empire gym... · orchard gym... · ladies gym... · ...reviews · ...photos	Brand names + "ladies" + people check reviews and photos
dholl puri	...near me · ...port louis · ...rose hill · ...curepipe · ...recipe	Local intent ("near me", towns) and a recipe intent

Start of the search	Suggestions from google.mu	What it tells us
apartment for rent	...in mauritius · ...port louis · ...curepipe · ...quatre bornes · ...flic en flac · ...moka	Town-by-town pages would match demand
plombier	...near me · ...mauritius · ...a domicile · ...quatre bornes · ...curepipe · ...vacoas	Services are searched in French with a town
cake mauritius	mauritius cake delivery · birthday... · bento... · wedding... · rasmalai cake...	Delivery and occasion keywords; local flavours
wedding photographer mauritius	...price · best... · wedding photography mauritius	People want prices: publish them or a range



Typing "hotel mauritius" shows suggestions for hotels **named** "Mauritius" in Italy and Germany (Forte dei Marmi, Riccione, Cologne) next to "grand baie" and "all inclusive". A good reminder that broad keywords are ambiguous.

Mauritius searches in three languages

Need	English	French	Kreol (spoken / social)
Rent a car	car rental mauritius	location voiture maurice	lwe loto
Cheap	cheap	pas cher	bon marse
Find food	dholl puri near me	où manger à port louis	kot pou manz dholl puri
Plumber	plumber quatre bornes	plombier quatre bornes	plonbie

In Mauritius: written Google searches are mostly French and English, often mixed ("location voiture pas cher grand baie"). Kreol appears more in voice searches, social media and messages to AI assistants; Google autocomplete offers almost no Kreol suggestions. Cover English and French on your website, and use Kreol where your audience speaks it (social posts, FAQs, videos).

Short (head) vs long-tail keywords

Short vs long-tail keywords

The longer the search, the fewer people type it, but the more ready they are to buy

hotel mauritius · huge volume · very hard (Booking, Expedia, big resorts) · vague intent

hotel grand baie · medium volume · hard

hotel grand baie all inclusive · clearer need

**family guesthouse with pool near
trou aux biches beach** · small volume ·
easy · ready to book

Small businesses win on the bottom of this list first. Ten long-tail keywords with 20 searches each often bring more bookings than one head keyword you never rank for.

How to find keywords for free (step by step)

1. **Brainstorm.** List 10 ways a customer would describe what the business sells, in English and French. Ask real customers and staff.
2. **Google autocomplete.** Type each idea slowly into google.mu. Add a letter after the phrase (a, b, c...) or a town name to see more suggestions.
3. **People also ask & Related searches.** Scroll the results page; note the questions and the related searches at the bottom.
4. **Look at competitors.** Open the top 3 results: what words do they use in titles and headings? What questions do they answer?
5. **Google Trends** (trends.google.com). Set the country to Mauritius to compare two keywords and see seasons (tourism peaks, school holidays, festivals).
6. **Google Keyword Planner** (free inside a Google Ads account) for approximate monthly volumes. Volumes in Mauritius are small: compare keywords rather than chase big numbers.
7. **Search Console** (Section 7): once the site is connected, it shows the real searches that already bring you visitors.
8. **Sort and choose.** Put each keyword in a spreadsheet with its intent and choose **one main keyword per page** (the keyword map below).

Keyword map: one page, one main topic

Example for the fictional Lagon Bleu guesthouse:

Page	Main keyword	Secondary keywords	Intent
Home	guesthouse trou aux biches	guest house trou aux biches, chambre d'hôte trou aux biches	Do/Buy
Rooms	family room with pool trou aux biches	chambre familiale piscine, self-catering	Do/Buy
Location / getting here	trou aux biches from airport	taxi airport trou aux biches price, bus	Know
Guide	things to do in trou aux biches	snorkeling trou aux biches, best beach north mauritius	Know
FR version	chambre d'hôte trou aux biches	location vacances trou aux biches	Do/Buy

Paid and free keyword tools

Tool	Free?	Good for
Google autocomplete, People also ask, Related searches	Free	Real local phrasing, questions
Google Trends	Free	Comparing keywords, seasonality in Mauritius
Google Keyword Planner	Free with an Ads account	Approximate volumes, ideas
Google Search Console	Free	Keywords you already appear for
Ubersuggest, Semrush, Ahrefs	Limited free use, then paid	Volumes, difficulty, competitor keywords, backlinks
AnswerThePublic, AlsoAsked	Limited free use	Questions people ask (great for AEO)

Volumes in Mauritius are small. Tools often show "0-10" or "10-100" searches a month for local keywords. That doesn't mean nobody searches: a keyword with 30 searches a month from people ready to book can be worth a lot.

SECTION 4

On-page SEO

On-page SEO is everything **on the page itself** that tells Google and visitors what the page is about and why it's the best answer. You control it completely.

Anatomy of a search result

What you control, and the guidelines for each part

Lagon Bleu Guesthouse
<https://lagonbleu.mu> > rooms-with-pool

Family Guesthouse in Trou aux Biches with Pool | Lagon Bleu

2 min from the beach. Breakfast, free parking and family rooms. Book direct on WhatsApp for the best price.

URL

Short, readable words with the keyword.

Title tag

Keyword first + place + brand. About 50-60 characters.

Meta description

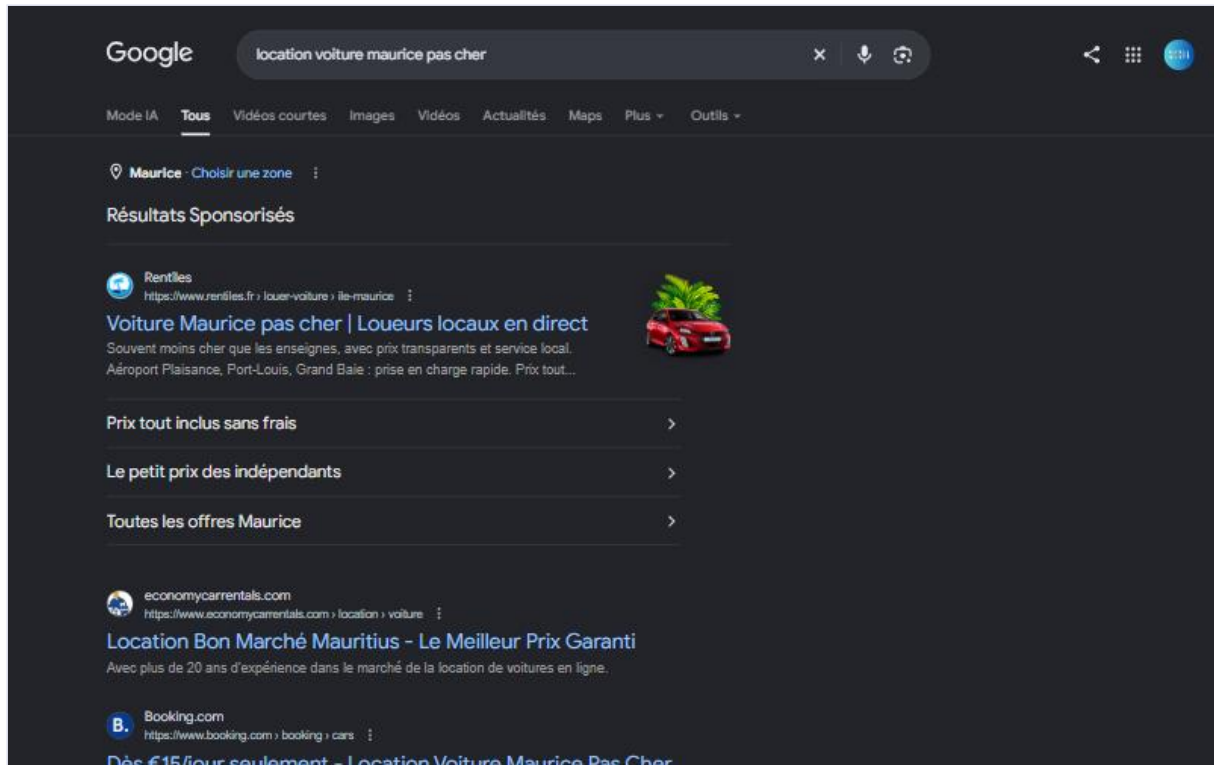
Benefit + proof + call to action. About 150-160 characters.

Fictional example. Google may rewrite titles and descriptions if they don't match the page well.

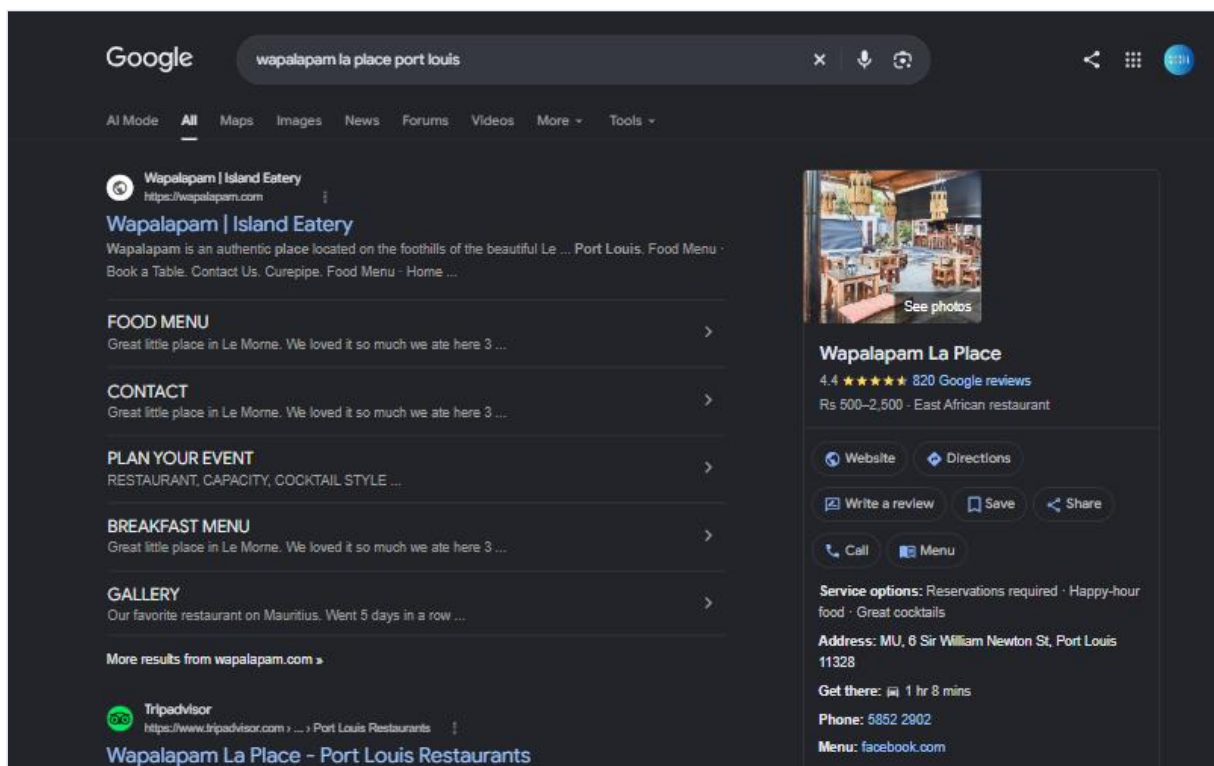
Title and meta description: before and after (fictional)

	Before (weak)	After (strong)
Title	Home	Family Guesthouse in Trou aux Biches with Pool Lagon Bleu
Description	Welcome to our website. Click here for more information.	2 min from the beach. Breakfast, free parking and family rooms. Book direct on WhatsApp for the best price.
Why	No keyword, no place, no reason to click	Keyword + place + benefits + call to action

Lessons from google.mu



French search "location voiture maurice pas cher". Booking.com's title copies the exact words of the search: "Location Voiture Maurice Pas Cher". economycarrentals.com uses "Location Bon Marché Mauritius". Titles that match the searcher's language and words get clicked.



Searching a brand name shows the website with **sitelinks** (Food menu, Contact, Plan your event...) and the **Google Business Profile** on the right. Note that three sitelinks (Food menu, Contact, Breakfast menu) show the same review text. When pages have no unique meta description, Google picks text from the page itself: worth checking on your own site.

The complete on-page checklist

Element	What to do	Guideline
Title tag	Main keyword first, then place, then brand. Unique for every page	About 50–60 characters
Meta description	Benefit + proof + call to action. Doesn't rank by itself but wins the click	About 150–160 characters, unique
URL	Short, readable, with the keyword, hyphens between words	/family-rooms not /page?id=12
H1 heading	One clear main heading with the keyword	1 per page
Subheadings (H2/H3)	Break the page into sections people can scan; questions make great H2s	Every 150–300 words
First paragraph	Say what the page is about and answer the main question immediately	First 100 words
Content	Complete, original, accurate, with local details, prices and photos	As long as needed, no filler
Images	Descriptive file name, alt text, compressed, modern format (WebP)	Ideally under 200 KB
Internal links	Link related pages with descriptive anchor text ("see our family rooms")	2–5 per page
External links	Link to useful official sources when relevant	Only trusted sites
Contact & trust	Phone, WhatsApp, address, map, opening hours, BRN (Business Registration Number), policies	Same as on Google
Structured data	Schema markup: code that describes the business, products, FAQs (Section 10)	JSON-LD format

Writing content that ranks

- **Answer the question better than the current top results.** Search the keyword, read the top 3, then cover what they miss: local tips, prices, photos, a table, a map.
- **Write for people first.** Use the keyword naturally in the title, H1, first paragraph and a few headings. Use synonyms and related words; Google understands meaning.
- **Show first-hand experience:** your own photos, staff names, real examples ("our guests usually..."). This is what generic and AI-written content lacks.
- **Make it scannable:** short paragraphs, bullet points, tables, bold key facts.
- **Keep it fresh:** update prices, opening hours and offers; show "last updated".
- **Avoid duplicate content:** don't copy supplier or competitor text; don't publish the same page for several towns with only the town name changed.
- **One keyword, one page:** if two of your pages target the same keyword, they compete with each other ("cannibalisation"). Merge them.

Keyword stuffing ("cheap car rental Mauritius, car rental Mauritius cheap...") makes the text unreadable and can hurt rankings. If it sounds strange read aloud, rewrite it.

Images and video

- File name: **family-room-pool-trou-aux-biches.webp**, not IMG_4032.jpg.
- Alt text describes the image for blind visitors and Google: "Family room with sea view at Lagon Bleu, Trou aux Biches".

- Compress images (Squoosh, TinyPNG) before uploading; phones produce 3–5 MB photos that slow pages down.
- Use real photos rather than stock: Google Images and Maps reward originals, and customers trust them more.
- Videos: upload to YouTube with a keyword-rich title and description, then embed on the page. YouTube results often appear on Google.

SECTION 5

Content strategy

Single pages rank for single keywords. A **content strategy** plans a set of pages that together show Google (and AI tools) that you are the reference on your topic in Mauritius.

Topic clusters: pillar + supporting pages

A **pillar page** covers a broad topic; **cluster pages** go deeper on each sub-question and link back to the pillar.

Pillar page	Cluster pages (linking to the pillar)
Car rental in Mauritius (the complete guide)	Airport pick-up and drop-off · Driving rules in Mauritius for tourists · Deposit and insurance explained · Best road trips in the north · Petrol prices and stations · Renting without a credit card
Wedding photography in Mauritius	Prices and packages · Best beach locations · Civil vs religious ceremonies: what to plan · Rainy-day backup ideas · Real weddings (portfolio stories)
Gym in Quatre Bornes	Ladies-only classes · Membership prices · Personal training · Beginners' first week · Parking and opening hours

Content types that work well

Type	Example (Mauritius)	Good for
Service / product page	Birthday cakes with delivery in Port Louis	Do/Buy keywords
Location page	Car rental in Grand Baie (real local info, not copy-paste)	Local keywords
Guide / how-to	How to register a business in Mauritius, step by step	Know keywords, AI answers
FAQ page	Deposit, insurance, airport delivery, payment by Juice	AEO, People also ask
Comparison	Bento cake vs classic cake: which to choose?	Decision stage
Price page	Wedding photography packages 2026 (Rs)	Often searched, rarely answered
Case study / story	A wedding in Le Morne: our day, our photos	Shows first-hand experience
Local list	10 places to eat dholl puri in Rose Hill	Links, shares, AI citations

Planning: a simple monthly rhythm

- **Week 1:** check Search Console for new questions and keywords; pick 1–2 topics.
- **Week 2:** write or update one page (new content, or improve an old page that is on page 2 of Google).

- **Week 3:** add photos, internal links, FAQ, and share the page on social media and Google Business Profile.
- **Week 4:** collect reviews and look for one link opportunity (partner, supplier, local media).

Tip: Updating beats publishing. Improving a page that already ranks in positions 8–20 often brings faster results than writing a new one. Search Console shows these pages (Section 7).

AI-written content: Google doesn't ban AI-assisted content, but it targets mass-produced pages with little value. Use AI to draft and structure, then add your own facts, photos, prices and experience, and check everything. Never publish AI text you haven't verified.

PART C

Technical SEO

Make sure Google can access,
read and trust your website

SECTION 6

Technical SEO

Technical SEO makes sure search engines can **crawl** and **index** your website, and that it works well on every device. You don't need to code: website builders (WordPress, Wix, Shopify, Squarespace) handle most of it if set up correctly. Your job is to check.

The technical checklist

Check	Why it matters	How to check (free)
Indexed	Pages not indexed can't rank	site:yourdomain.mu · Search Console → Pages
Mobile-friendly	Google ranks the mobile version first; most Mauritian searches are on phones	Open the site on your phone; PageSpeed Insights mobile test
Speed	Slow pages lose visitors, especially on mobile data	PageSpeed Insights (pagespeed.web.dev)
Secure (https)	Browsers warn visitors on non-secure sites; trust signal	Padlock in the address bar
XML sitemap	A list of your pages for search engines	yourdomain.mu/sitemap.xml
robots.txt	Tells robots what not to crawl. One wrong line can block the whole site	yourdomain.mu/robots.txt
No broken pages	404 errors waste visits and links	Search Console → Pages; a link checker
Redirects	Old URLs should send visitors and Google to the new page (301)	Type old URLs and see where they go
One version of the site	http/https and www/non-www must redirect to one	Type the 4 versions
Canonical tags	Tell Google which version of similar pages is the main one	View page source: rel="canonical"
Languages (hreflang)	Links EN and FR versions so each searcher gets the right one	Multilingual plugin settings
Structured data	Helps Google understand the business, products, reviews	Rich Results Test (Section 10)

Core Web Vitals: Google's user-experience scores

Metric	Measures	Good score	Common fixes
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	How fast the main content appears	2.5 seconds or less	Compress images, better hosting, caching
INP (Interaction to Next Paint)	How fast the page reacts to taps and clicks	200 ms or less	Fewer heavy plugins and scripts
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	Whether the page jumps while loading	0.1 or less	Set image sizes; avoid pop-ups pushing content

Speed matters, but content matters more: a fast empty page won't rank. Aim for "good enough" and fix the biggest problems first (usually huge images).

Site structure

- Every important page should be reachable in **3 clicks** from the home page.

- Use a clear menu: Home · Services/Rooms/Products · Prices · About · Reviews · Blog/Guides · Contact.
- Use breadcrumbs on bigger sites (Home > Cars > SUV rental).
- Avoid "orphan" pages that nothing links to: Google may never find them.

Platform tips

Platform	What to set up
WordPress	An SEO plugin (Yoast, Rank Math) for titles, descriptions, sitemap and schema; a caching plugin; compress images; keep plugins few and updated
Wix / Squarespace	Use the built-in SEO settings per page; connect Search Console from the dashboard; check mobile view
Shopify	Edit product titles/descriptions for search; avoid duplicate product descriptions from suppliers; compress product images
Facebook page only	Not enough on its own: create at least a Google Business Profile and, ideally, a simple website you own

Changing website or domain? Plan 301 redirects from every old URL to the new one before launch. Many Mauritian businesses lose years of rankings after a redesign because old pages simply disappear.

SECTION 7

Google Search Console, step by step

Google Search Console is a free tool from Google that shows how your site appears in search: which searches show it, how many clicks it gets, which pages are indexed and what problems Google found. Every website should have it.

Setting it up (15 minutes)

1. Go to **search.google.com/search-console** and sign in with the business Google account (not a personal one that may leave with an employee).
2. Click **Add property**. Choose **Domain** (covers http/https, www and all sub-domains) or **URL prefix** (simpler if you can't edit DNS).
3. **Verify ownership**. Domain: add the TXT record (a small text setting) Google gives you in your domain's DNS settings, at your domain provider. URL prefix: upload an HTML file, add a meta tag, or use Google Analytics / Tag Manager. Many builders (Wix, Shopify, WordPress plugins) have a one-click option.
4. Go to **Sitemaps**, enter **sitemap.xml** (or the address your builder gives) and submit.
5. Go to **Settings → Users and permissions** and add your marketing team or agency with the right access level.
6. Link Search Console to **GA4** (Week 2) to see search data next to visits and conversions.
7. Wait a few days for data, then review the reports below each month.

The reports that matter

Report	What it shows	What to do with it
Performance → Search results	Queries, pages, clicks, impressions, CTR, average position; filter by country and device	Find keywords in positions 5–20 and improve those pages; rewrite titles with a low CTR (click-through rate)
Pages (Indexing)	Indexed and not-indexed pages, with reasons	Fix "Not found (404)", "Blocked by robots.txt", "Duplicate" issues
URL inspection	How Google sees one page; last crawl	After updating a page, click "Request indexing"
Sitemaps	Whether the sitemap was read	Check it shows "Success"
Core Web Vitals	Speed and stability of real visits	Fix "Poor" URLs first
Links	Top linking sites and internal links	See who links to you; spot pages with few internal links
Manual actions / Security	Penalties or hacking	Should say "No issues detected"

Three quick wins from Search Console

1. **Low CTR:** Performance → Pages, sort by impressions. A page with many impressions but CTR under 2% needs a better title and description.
2. **Almost there:** Performance → Queries, filter Position between 8 and 20. These keywords are on page 1–2; improve the page that ranks for them (add a section, FAQ, internal links).
3. **New questions:** filter queries containing "how", "what", "comment", "combien", "price". Answer them on your pages (AEO, Section 10).

Also set up Bing Webmaster Tools

Go to **bing.com/webmasters** and import your site from Search Console in one click. Bing's index powers Microsoft Copilot and is one of the sources used by ChatGPT search, so it matters more in the AI era (Section 11). Bing also supports **IndexNow**, a way to notify it instantly when pages change (many WordPress SEO plugins include it).

PART D

Local SEO & reputation

Win on Google Maps, and earn
the reviews and links that build trust

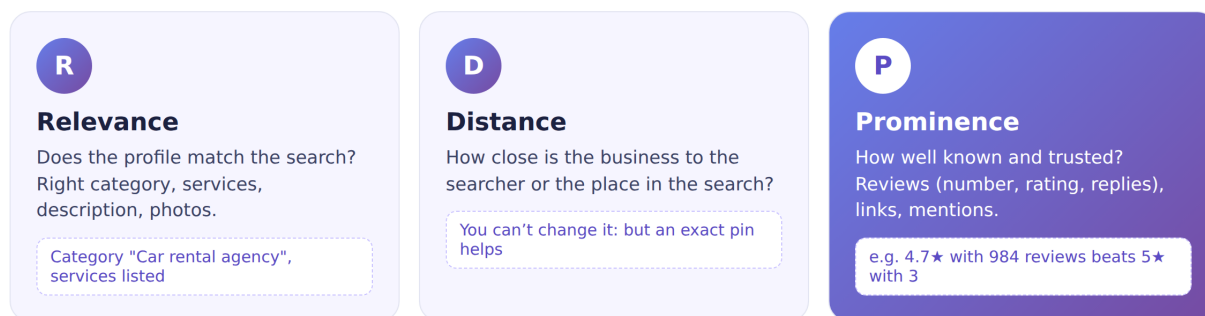
SECTION 8

Local SEO and Google Business Profile

For most small businesses in Mauritius, the **Google Business Profile** (the card on Google Maps and Search) is the fastest and cheapest SEO win. It is free, it appears in the map pack, in "near me" searches and on Maps, often above all websites, and AI tools use it as a source.

How Google ranks businesses on Maps

Google's three local ranking factors



Google's own explanation of local ranking: relevance, distance and prominence.

Setting up or claiming your profile

1. Go to **business.google.com** and search the business name: it may already exist (created by Google or a customer). If so, **claim** it; if someone else manages it, request access.
2. Enter the business name **exactly as on the sign**. Adding keywords to the name ("Lagon Bleu Best Guesthouse Trou aux Biches") breaks Google's rules and can get the profile suspended.
3. Choose the most precise **primary category** ("Guest house", "Car rental agency", "Cake shop"). Add a few secondary categories.
4. Set the **address and map pin** exactly. Many Mauritian addresses have no street number: use the road, village and a landmark. Service businesses that visit customers (plumbers, caterers) can hide the address and set a service area.
5. Add phone, website, and opening hours.
6. **Verify** the business. Google chooses the method (often a short video showing the location, signage and proof of management; sometimes phone, email or postcard).

The complete profile checklist

- ☐ Name exactly as on the sign; correct primary and secondary categories
- ☐ Description (750 characters) in English and French, with what you do, where, and what makes you different
- ☐ Services or products with prices where possible; menu link for restaurants; booking link
- ☐ Opening hours, plus **special hours** for public holidays (Diwali, Christmas, Eid, Cavadee, Independence Day...)
- ☐ Phone number that is answered; WhatsApp and website links
- ☐ Attributes: wheelchair access, parking, Wi-Fi, outdoor seating, women-led, payment options
- ☐ At least 10–20 real photos: outside (so people find you), inside, team, products, plus a logo and cover. Add new ones every month
- ☐ Posts for offers, events and news (they show on the profile)
- ☐ Reply to every review, in the reviewer's language
- ☐ Check the profile monthly: anyone can suggest edits, and Google may accept them

Section 4 shows what a filled-in profile looks like in the results: photos, rating, category, buttons for website, directions and calls, hours and phone.

NAP consistency and local citations

NAP = Name, Address, Phone. Use exactly the same details on your website, Google profile, Facebook, Instagram, Tripadvisor, Booking, directories and partner sites. Every listing of your NAP elsewhere is a **citation**: consistent citations confirm to Google (and AI tools) that you are real and where you are.

Type of listing	Examples for Mauritius
Maps and search	Google Business Profile, Bing Places, Apple Business (formerly Apple Business Connect, for Apple Maps)
Social	Facebook page, Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn company page
Tourism and food	Tripadvisor, Booking.com, Airbnb, the official tourism site (mymauritius.travel) where eligible
Directories	Local yellow pages and business directories; chamber of commerce and industry association member lists
Partners	Suppliers, tour operators, wedding planners, event venues that list their partners

Location pages on your website

If you serve several towns (a plumber in Quatre Bornes, Vacoas and Curepipe), create a page per town only if you can make each one genuinely useful: local jobs done, photos, travel time, local reviews, prices. Copy-paste pages with only the town name changed can be treated as spam.

Off-page SEO: reviews, links and reputation

Off-page SEO is what **other people and websites** say about you. Each review, link or mention is a vote of confidence that Google, AI tools and customers notice.

Reviews: the most important off-page signal for local businesses

- **Ask every customer**, at the right moment: after a great meal, at check-out, when delivering a cake. Use a QR code at the counter and the short review link from your Google profile in WhatsApp messages and receipts.
- **Make it easy**: send a direct link so it's one tap away. Suggest what to mention ("which room you stayed in") without dictating the text.
- **Reply to all reviews**, within a few days, in the reviewer's language. Replies show future customers you care.
- **Spread across platforms** that matter in your sector: Google first, then Tripadvisor/Booking (tourism), Facebook (locals).
- **Use reviews in marketing**: quote them (with permission) on your site and social posts.

Never buy, fake, incentivise or "gate" reviews (offering discounts in exchange for reviews, or only inviting the customers you expect to be happy). It breaks Google's rules, reviews can be removed, profiles can be suspended, and in a small market like Mauritius people notice.

How to answer a negative review

1. Thank the person and apologise for the experience, without arguing.
2. Explain briefly what you have done or will do to fix it.
3. Invite them to contact you directly (phone/WhatsApp) to resolve it.
4. Keep it short and calm: future customers read your reply more than the complaint.

Backlinks: links from other websites to yours

Google sees a link from a respected site as a recommendation. **Quality beats quantity**: one link from a well-known Mauritian news site or association is worth more than 100 links from random directories.

Tactic	Mauritian example
Partners and suppliers	A wedding planner links to its photographer; a tour operator links to the guesthouses it uses
Local media and PR	A story in a local news site about your opening, award, new product or community action
Useful content others cite	A clear "petrol and road guide for tourists" or "price guide" that bloggers and forums link to
Associations and events	Member listings (tourism, chamber of commerce), sponsoring a local event or sports club
Creators and bloggers	A food blogger reviews your restaurant and links to your menu
Unlinked mentions	Find articles that mention your name without a link and politely ask for one

Avoid link schemes: buying links, link exchanges in bulk, comment spam and private blog networks can trigger a Google penalty. If someone sells "1,000 backlinks for Rs 2,000", walk away.

Brand mentions and social signals

Social media likes don't directly improve rankings, but an active presence creates searches for your brand, mentions, reviews and links, all of which do. Brand mentions without links also matter more and more for AI tools, which learn which brands are associated with which topics (Section 11).

PART E

SEO in the age of AI

AEO: be the answer.

GEO: be recommended by AI.

SECTION 10

AEO: Answer Engine Optimisation

AEO means structuring your content so search engines and assistants can take it and give it as **the direct answer**: in featured snippets, "People also ask", voice assistants and AI Overviews. People increasingly get the answer without clicking, so being the quoted source is the new "position 1".

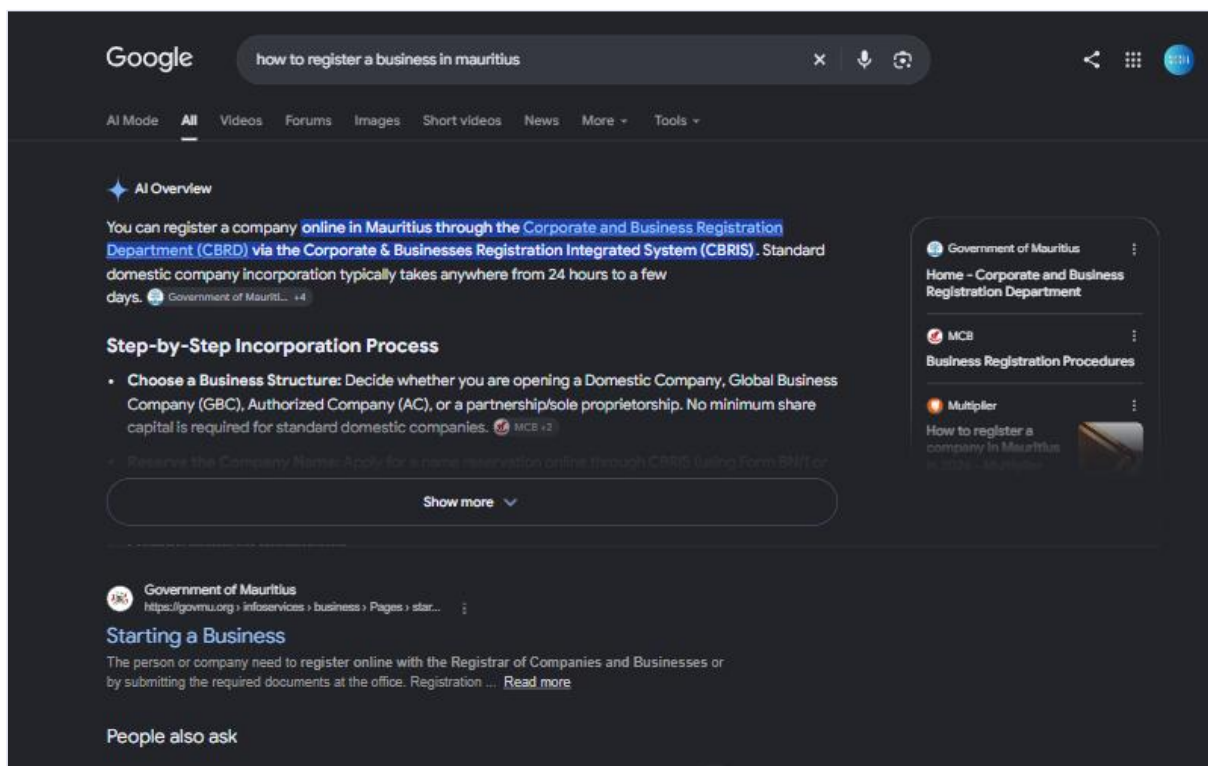
SEO, AEO and GEO: what's the difference?

Three goals, one foundation

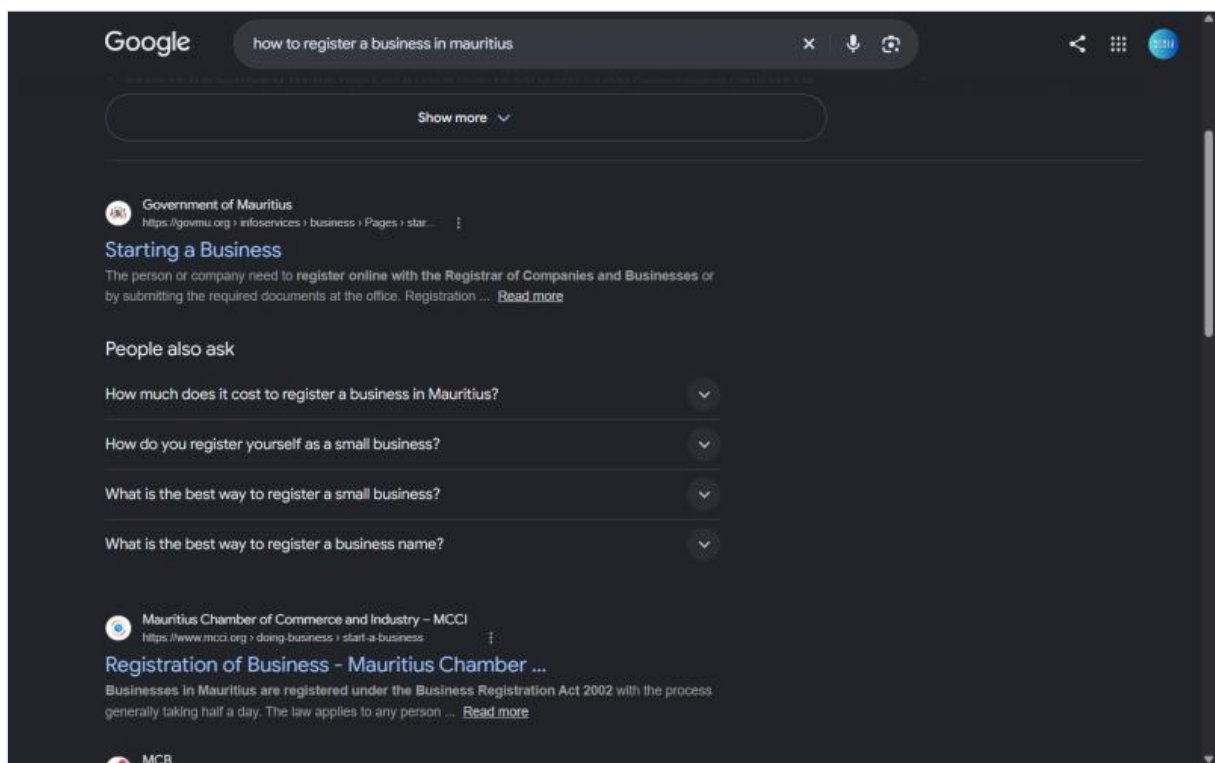
SEO	AEO	GEO
Search Engine Optimisation	Answer Engine Optimisation	Generative Engine Optimisation
Goal: rank in the blue links and the map pack.	Goal: be the direct answer.	Goal: be cited or recommended by AI.
Where: Google, Bing, Google Maps.	Where: featured snippets, People also ask, voice assistants, AI Overviews.	Where: ChatGPT, Gemini, Google AI Mode, Perplexity, Copilot.
Success: clicks to your site, calls, directions.	Success: your answer is shown or read out.	Success: your brand is mentioned, linked or recommended.

Shared foundation: clear, accurate, helpful content + a trusted, consistent brand + a technically healthy site

AEO and GEO don't replace SEO: they build on it. Most AI answers are built from pages that already rank well.



Search "how to register a business in mauritius": an **AI Overview** answers at the top, with step-by-step bullets. On the right, its sources: the Government of Mauritius portal, MCB and Multiplier. Below, the first organic result is govmu.org. Clear, official, structured pages get cited.



Same search, further down: **People also ask**. "How much does it cost to register a business in Mauritius?", "How do you register yourself as a small business?"... Each question is a content idea and a chance to be the quoted answer. Below: the MCCI page, another trusted source.

Where answers appear

Feature	What it is	How to win it
Featured snippet	A boxed answer above or near the top of results	A 40-60 word direct answer right under a question heading; lists and tables for "steps" or "prices"
People also ask	Expandable related questions	Answer each related question in its own short section
AI Overviews / AI Mode	Google's AI answers with source links	Clear, accurate, trusted content that ranks; specific facts
Voice assistants	Answers read aloud (Gemini, Siri, Alexa)	Short conversational answers; complete Google Business Profile for "near me"
Knowledge panel	Box about a business or brand	Google Business Profile, consistent info, structured data

How to write a page that AI and Google can quote

The answer-first structure for each question

H2 question: How much does it cost to rent a car in Mauritius?

Direct answer (40-60 words): A small car costs about Rs X per day ... (facts, numbers, conditions)

Details: table of prices by car type, what's included, deposit, insurance

Proof: reviews, photos, date updated, who wrote it

Next step: book on WhatsApp / call

One question, one block

Each section must make sense on its own: AI tools lift passages, not whole pages.

Facts beat adjectives

"Rs 1,800/day, airport pick-up included" beats "affordable premium service".

Keep it current

Show the date updated. Outdated prices make AI and customers distrust you.

AEO writing rules

- **Use real questions as headings**, in the words people use (from People also ask, autocomplete, your customers' WhatsApp messages).
- **Answer in the first sentence** under the heading, then add details. Don't make people (or AI) read three paragraphs of introduction.
- **Be specific:** numbers, prices in rupees, durations, addresses, names. "The airport is 1h15 from Trou aux Biches by taxi, about Rs 2,000-2,500" is quotable; "we are conveniently located" is not.
- **Use lists and tables** for steps, comparisons and prices.
- **One page can answer many questions:** a good FAQ section at the bottom of each service page is ideal.
- **Answer in both English and French** if your customers ask in both.

Structured data (schema markup)

Structured data is a small piece of code that labels your information for machines: "this is a business, this is its address, these are its opening hours". It doesn't guarantee anything but helps Google and other systems understand your page, and can make you eligible for **rich results** (results with extras such as stars, prices or event dates). Most website builders and CMS plugins (CMS = content management system, like WordPress) add it without coding. Example for a local business (JSON-LD, placed in the page):

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "LodgingBusiness",
  "name": "Lagon Bleu Guesthouse",
  "url": "https://lagonbleu.mu",
  "telephone": "+230 5XXX XXXX",
  "address": {
    "@type": "PostalAddress",
    "streetAddress": "Coastal Road",
    "addressLocality": "Trou aux Biches",
    "addressCountry": "MU"
  },
  "openingHours": "Mo-Su 07:00-21:00",
  "priceRange": "Rs 2,500 - Rs 4,500",
  "sameAs": ["https://www.facebook.com/example", "https://www.instagram.com/example"]
}
</script>
```

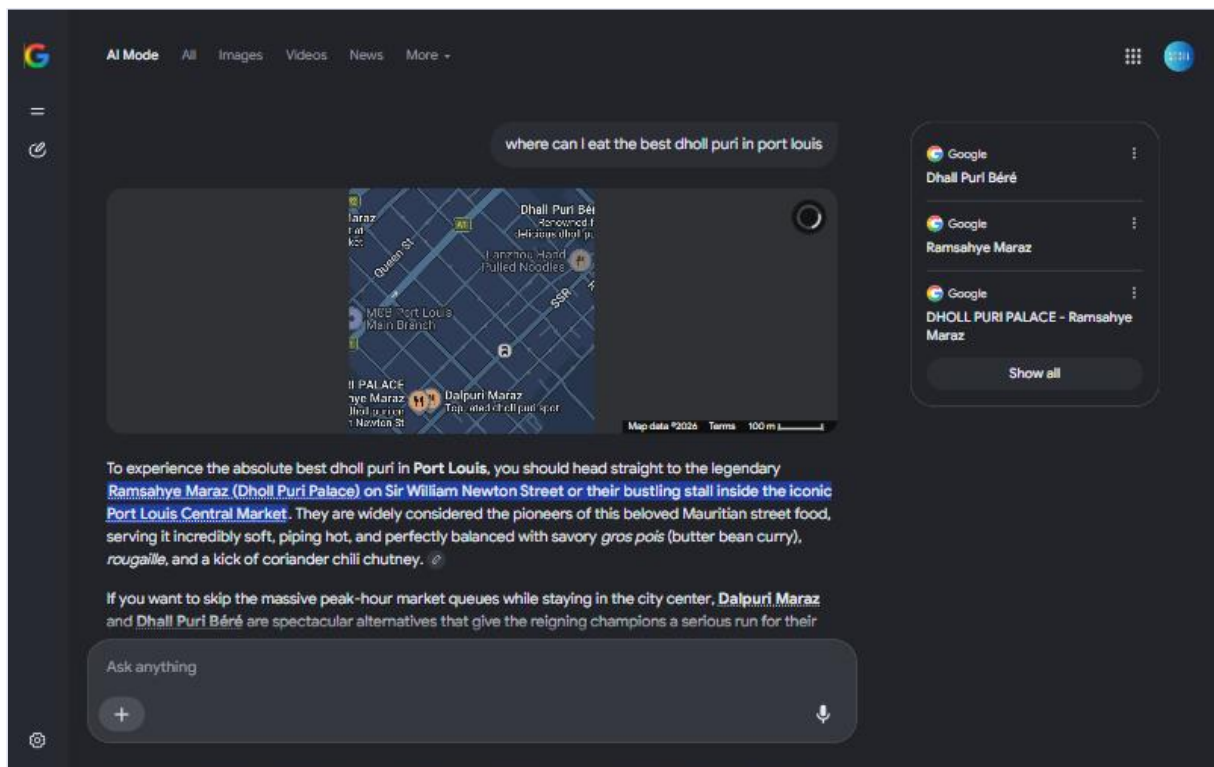
Schema type	Use it for
LocalBusiness (and sub-types: Restaurant, LodgingBusiness, Store...)	Your business details on the home and contact pages
Organization	Logo, social profiles (sameAs), contact: helps build your brand "entity"
Product / Offer	E-commerce products with price and availability
Review / AggregateRating	Genuine reviews shown on the page. Google doesn't show stars for a business's reviews of itself on its own site
FAQPage	Q&A sections. Google stopped showing FAQ rich results in May 2026, but the markup still helps machines read your answers
Event	Concerts, workshops, festivals with dates
Article / BreadcrumbList	Blog posts and site structure

Tip: test your page with Google's **Rich Results Test** (search.google.com/test/rich-results) and the **Schema Markup Validator** (validator.schema.org). Only mark up what is visible on the page.

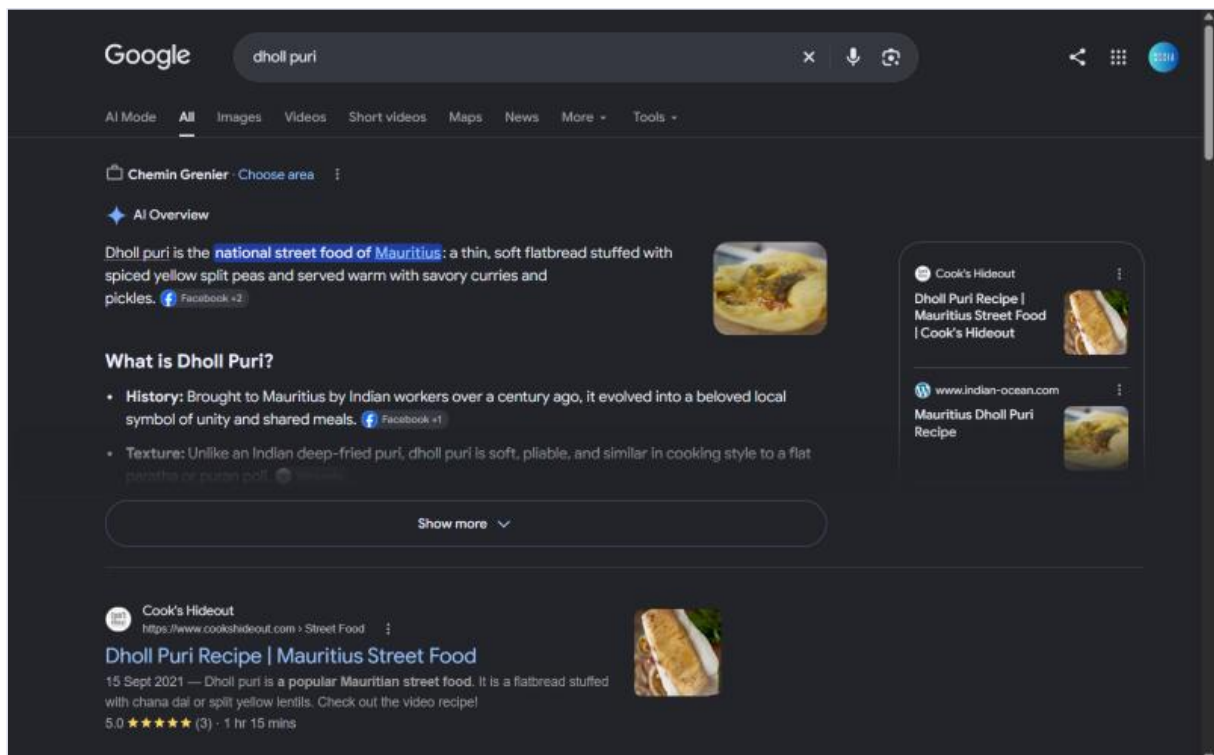
SECTION 11

GEO: Generative Engine Optimisation

GEO (sometimes called AI SEO or LLM optimisation) means making your business and content likely to be **mentioned, cited and recommended** by generative AI: Google AI Overviews and AI Mode, ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Microsoft Copilot and Claude. It is a young field, and the best practices keep evolving.



Google **AI Mode**, question "where can I eat the best dhol puri in port louis". The AI recommends Ramsahye Maraz (Dholl Puri Palace) on Sir William Newton Street and at the Central Market, then Dalpuri Maraz and Dholl Puri Béré, with a map. Its sources on the right are **Google Maps listings**: a complete Business Profile with reviews is a big part of why these businesses appear.



Search "dhol puri": the AI Overview cites **Facebook posts** and a recipe site (Cook's Hideout). AI tools draw on many sources, including social media, forums and directories, not only websites.

How AI tools choose what to say

Tool	Where its answers come from (simplified)
Google AI Overviews / AI Mode	Google's search index, Google Maps / Business Profiles, Shopping data. Pages that rank well and answer clearly are cited most
ChatGPT	What the model learned in training + live web search (using search partners, including Bing) when browsing
Microsoft Copilot	Bing's index
Gemini	Google's index and Google services
Perplexity	Its own live web search, always with numbered citations

Two ways to appear: (1) the model already "knows" your brand from what was written about it across the web; (2) the tool searches the web live and finds and cites your page. GEO works on both.

The GEO playbook

1. **Do the SEO basics first.** AI tools that search live mostly use pages that already rank. Sections 3–9 are the foundation.
2. **Complete your Google Business Profile, Bing Places and Apple Business.** For local questions ("best dhol puri in Port Louis"), AI answers are often built from these listings and their reviews.
3. **Be an "entity" with a clear identity.** Same name, description, address, phone, logo and founder names everywhere. Add Organization/LocalBusiness schema with "sameAs" links to your social profiles. Consistency helps AI connect the dots.
4. **Get mentioned on the sites AI trusts and reads:** local news, Wikipedia where you genuinely qualify, industry associations, Tripadvisor, Reddit and forum discussions, "best of" lists, YouTube. Mentions (even without links) shape what AI says about you.
5. **Write quotable content:** answer-first, factual, specific, with statistics and sources, each section able to stand alone (Section 10). AI tools lift passages, not whole pages.
6. **Show E-E-A-T** (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust: see the box below): real authors with bios, first-hand photos and experience, clear "about" and contact pages, reviews.
7. **Keep facts current and identical everywhere.** Outdated prices or hours on one site can end up in an AI answer.
8. **Let AI crawlers in** (see robots.txt below) and keep important content in plain HTML text, not only inside images or PDFs.
9. **Cover the full conversation.** People ask AI longer questions with context ("I'm travelling with two kids and need a car with a child seat from the airport"). Create content for these situations: comparisons, "best for...", pros and cons, prices.
10. **Measure and repeat** (below).

E-E-A-T: how Google judges quality

Google's guidelines for its quality raters. Trust is the centre.

EXPERIENCE

Have you done it?

Real photos, first-hand stories, "we tested", local knowledge.

EXPERTISE

Do you know it?

Qualifications, author bios, accurate details, years in business.

AUTHORITATIVENESS

Do others recognise you?

Links and mentions from respected sites, press, associations.

TRUST

Can people rely on you?

Contact details, BRN, policies, https, honest reviews, correct prices.

E-E-A-T comes from Google's quality rater guidelines. It is not a single ranking factor, but it describes what both Google and AI tools look for.

AI crawlers and robots.txt

AI companies use robots to read websites. You can allow or block them in **robots.txt**. Blocking search-related bots can keep you out of AI answers.

Robot (user-agent)	Company	Used for
Googlebot	Google	Search, including AI Overviews and AI Mode (blocking it removes you from Google)
Google-Extended	Google	Control over use of your content for training Gemini; does not affect Search rankings
Bingbot	Microsoft	Bing search and Copilot
OAI-SearchBot	OpenAI	Showing your site in ChatGPT search results
GPTBot	OpenAI	Training OpenAI models
ChatGPT-User	OpenAI	Pages ChatGPT opens when a user asks it to
PerplexityBot	Perplexity	Perplexity search answers
ClaudeBot	Anthropic	Training Claude models
Claude-SearchBot	Anthropic	Claude search answers

For most businesses that want visibility, allow at least Googlebot, Bingbot, OAI-SearchBot, Claude-SearchBot and PerplexityBot. Whether to allow training bots is a business choice.

llms.txt: optional

llms.txt is a proposed text file (yourdomain.mu/llms.txt) that lists your most important pages in a simple format for AI tools. It is not an official standard and major search engines say they don't use it for ranking, so treat it as a low-cost extra, never a priority.

Measuring AI visibility

- **Prompt test, monthly:** write 10–20 questions your customers would ask ("best car rental at Mauritius airport without deposit", "où acheter un gâteau d'anniversaire à Port Louis"). Ask them in ChatGPT, Gemini, Google AI Mode, Perplexity and Copilot. Note: are you mentioned? Cited with a link? Which competitors and sources appear?
- **GA4 referrals:** in Reports → Acquisition → Traffic acquisition, look at sessions from **chatgpt.com, perplexity.ai, gemini.google.com, copilot.microsoft.com**. Create a custom channel group "AI assistants" to track them.

- **Search Console:** AI Overview and AI Mode clicks are counted inside the normal Performance report (not separated). Watch for pages with rising impressions but falling clicks.
- **Brand searches:** more people searching your brand name is a good sign that AI and word-of-mouth recommend you.
- **Tools:** paid tools (Semrush, Ahrefs, Ubersuggest and specialist AI-visibility trackers) now monitor brand mentions in AI answers.

Prompt (example)	ChatGPT	Gemini	AI Mode	Perplexity	Others named
best guesthouse trou aux biches for families					
chambre d'hôte pas cher trou aux biches					
where to stay near trou aux biches beach with kids					

A simple AI visibility tracker: write Y (mentioned), L (linked) or – (absent) each month.

Be careful with "GEO hacks": hidden text for AI, fake reviews, mass AI-generated pages or paid "AI ranking" guarantees. AI tools and search engines actively filter manipulation, and the reputational risk is high.

PART F

Put it to work

Playbooks, measurement, checklists
and your SEO Action Plan

Playbooks by type of business

The priorities depend on the business. Here are the top actions for common Mauritian business types, in order.

Hotel, guesthouse, villa

1. Google Business Profile complete with 30+ photos, attributes and special hours; reply to all reviews on Google, Tripadvisor and Booking
2. Website with a direct-booking page, room pages, prices, and an EN + FR version (add German/Italian if those markets matter)
3. Local guide content: beaches, activities, transport from the airport, rainy days
4. Hotel schema; listing on the official tourism site where eligible; links from tour operators and wedding planners
5. Don't fight Booking.com on broad keywords: be excellent on the platforms and win on specific searches

Restaurant, café, street food

1. Google Business Profile: correct category, menu link, food photos updated monthly, hours (including holidays), price range
2. Reviews: QR code on tables and receipts; reply to all
3. Website or at least a mobile-friendly menu page in HTML (not only a PDF or Facebook photo)
4. Instagram / TikTok / Facebook: food creators and bloggers often drive links and mentions
5. Restaurant schema with menu, cuisine, opening hours

Shop and e-commerce

1. Unique product titles and descriptions (never the supplier's copy), real photos, prices in rupees, delivery info
2. Category pages written for search ("bento cake mauritius", "school shoes port louis")
3. Product schema, fast mobile checkout, payment methods listed (cards, Juice, cash on delivery)
4. Google Merchant Center (free listings in Google Shopping)
5. Google Business Profile if you have a physical shop or pick-up point

Services (plumber, salon, gym, accountant, lawyer)

1. Google Business Profile with service area, services and prices; reviews that mention the service and town
2. One page per main service, with prices or price ranges, process, FAQs and photos of real work
3. Location pages for the towns you serve, only if they contain genuine local content
4. Trust signals: qualifications, BRN (Business Registration Number), years in business, team photos, guarantees
5. For professional services: helpful guides ("how to register a business in Mauritius") build authority and AI citations

Real estate and car rental

1. Listings with unique text, many photos, price, location and key facts in HTML text
2. Area guides (Grand Baie, Moka, Flic en Flac...) and practical guides (buying as a foreigner, deposit and insurance explained)
3. Google Business Profile per branch; reviews mentioning the area
4. French and English versions; clear answers to the questions autocomplete shows ("sans caution", "aéroport")

SECTION 13

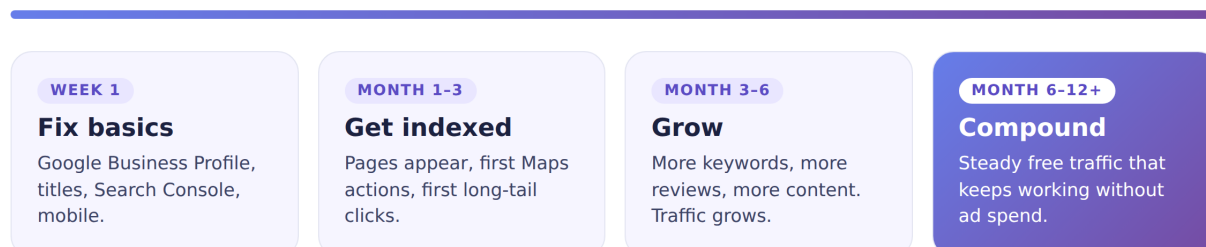
Measuring and reporting

SEO is a long-term investment. Track progress monthly, compare with the same month last year when you can, and focus on business results (calls, bookings, sales), not only rankings.

Metric	Where	What it tells you
Impressions	Search Console	How often you appeared in Google results
Clicks	Search Console	How many people clicked through to your site
CTR (click-through rate)	Search Console	Clicks ÷ impressions. Low CTR? Improve the title and description
Average position	Search Console	Your average ranking for a query or page
Organic sessions & conversions	GA4 (Week 2)	Visits from free search and what they did (forms, WhatsApp clicks, purchases)
Calls, directions, website clicks, bookings	Google Business Profile → Performance	Actions from Google Maps and Search
Reviews (count and rating)	Google, Tripadvisor, Facebook	Reputation trend
Indexed pages, errors	Search Console → Pages	Technical health
AI visibility	Prompt tests, GA4 referrals (Section 11)	Whether AI tools mention and send visitors

A realistic SEO timeline

Typical path for a small Mauritian business that keeps working on it



A typical path, not a promise: it depends on competition, the website's history and the effort. Be careful with anyone who guarantees "page 1 in a week".

A one-page monthly SEO report

Section	Content
1. Headline	One sentence: what improved, what didn't, why
2. Numbers	Clicks, impressions, CTR, organic conversions, GBP actions, reviews: this month vs last month vs last year
3. Wins	New keywords on page 1, pages that improved, new links or mentions, AI mentions
4. Problems	Errors in Search Console, drops, negative reviews
5. Next month	3-5 actions with owner and deadline

SECTION 14

Google updates, penalties and myths

Google changes its ranking systems thousands of times a year, and announces bigger "core updates" a few times a year. Sites that focus on genuinely helpful content and real reputation usually do well over time.

Penalties

Type	What happens	What to do
Manual action	A Google reviewer penalises the site for spam (bought links, hidden text, scraped content). Shown in Search Console	Fix the problem, then submit a reconsideration request
Algorithmic drop	Rankings fall after an update; no message	Review content quality and E-E-A-T, compare with the sites that rose, improve. Recovery can take months
Hacked site	Spam pages or redirects added by hackers	Clean the site, update the CMS and plugins, change passwords, check Search Console Security

White hat vs black hat

White hat (safe)	Black hat (risky)
Helpful original content	Copied, spun or mass AI content
Earned links and mentions	Bought links, link farms, spam comments
Genuine reviews	Fake or incentivised reviews
Accurate business name	Keyword-stuffed business name on Google Maps
Visible text for users	Hidden text or cloaking (showing Google something different)

Common SEO myths

Myth	Reality
"SEO is a one-time job"	It is ongoing: competitors, Google and customers keep changing
"Paying for Google Ads improves SEO"	Ads and organic rankings are separate
"More pages = better"	A few excellent pages beat many thin ones
"Meta keywords tag helps"	Google ignores it
"SEO is dead because of AI"	AI answers are built largely from content that search engines index and rank. SEO evolves into SEO + AEO + GEO
"I can guarantee #1 on Google"	Nobody can. Google itself warns against such promises

SECTION 15

Checklists and glossary

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Targeting only broad keywords ("hotel mauritius")	Go specific and local ("family guesthouse trou aux biches")
Same title or description on every page	Unique title and description per page
Keyword stuffing	Write naturally for people
Copying text from other websites or suppliers	Write your own, with local details
Ignoring mobile and speed	Test on your own phone and PageSpeed Insights
Menu or prices only as images or PDFs	Put key information in HTML text
Incomplete Google Business Profile	Fill every field, add photos monthly
Ignoring reviews (or only answering good ones)	Reply to every review
Different name/address/phone across sites	Keep NAP identical everywhere
Redesigning a site without redirects	Map old URLs to new ones (301)
Blocking AI search bots by accident	Check robots.txt
Expecting results in a week	Plan for months; track monthly

Master checklist

Technical

- ☐ Site works well on a phone and loads fast (PageSpeed Insights)
- ☐ https padlock; one version of the site
- ☐ Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools set up; sitemap submitted
- ☐ No important pages blocked in robots.txt; no 404s on key pages
- ☐ site: search shows the main pages

Keywords & on-page

- ☐ Keyword map: one main keyword per page, EN and FR
- ☐ Unique title (50–60 characters) and description (150–160) on every page
- ☐ One H1, clear H2s (questions where useful)

- ☐ Original, helpful content with local details, prices and photos
- ☐ Images compressed with descriptive names and alt text
- ☐ Internal links between related pages
- ☐ Contact details, map and opening hours visible

Local & off-page

- ☐ Google Business Profile claimed, verified and complete; Bing Places and Apple Business
- ☐ Same NAP everywhere; main directories and platforms listed
- ☐ Monthly plan to get new reviews; all reviews answered
- ☐ 3-5 local websites that could link to you identified and contacted

AEO & GEO

- ☐ FAQ sections with answer-first replies to real questions
- ☐ LocalBusiness / Organization schema with sameAs links; tested
- ☐ Author and "about" information that shows experience and trust
- ☐ Mentions on trusted local sites, platforms and media
- ☐ AI search bots allowed in robots.txt
- ☐ Monthly prompt test in ChatGPT, Gemini, AI Mode, Perplexity; AI referrals tracked in GA4

Glossary

Term	Meaning
SEO	Search Engine Optimisation: improving free visibility in search engines
AEO	Answer Engine Optimisation: structuring content to be the direct answer (snippets, voice, AI Overviews)
GEO	Generative Engine Optimisation: being mentioned and cited by AI tools like ChatGPT and Gemini
SERP	Search Engine Results Page
Organic results	Free, unpaid results
Keyword / query	The words people type or say into a search engine
Search intent	The reason behind a search: know, go, local, do/buy
Long-tail keyword	A longer, more specific search with less competition
Crawl / Index / Rank	Visit pages / store them / order them for a search
Title tag	The clickable headline of a result
Meta description	The text under the title in a result
H1, H2	The main heading and the subheadings of a page
Alt text	A description of an image for Google and screen readers
Internal link / backlink	A link between your own pages / a link from another site to yours
Anchor text	The clickable words of a link
NAP / citation	Name, Address, Phone / a listing of your NAP on another site
Google Business Profile	Free business listing on Google Search and Maps
Map pack / Places	The map with local businesses in the results
Featured snippet	A highlighted answer box in the results
People also ask (PAA)	Related questions shown in the results
AI Overview / AI Mode	AI-generated answers inside Google Search
LLM	Large Language Model: the technology behind ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude
Entity	A thing Google and AI recognise as unique (your brand, a place, a person)
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust
Structured data / schema	Code that labels page information for machines
Sitemap / robots.txt	List of your pages / file telling robots what to crawl
Canonical	Tag naming the main version of similar pages
301 redirect	Permanent redirect from an old URL to a new one
Core Web Vitals	Google's speed and stability scores (LCP, INP, CLS)
Search Console	Free Google tool showing how your site performs in search
CTR	Click-through rate: clicks divided by impressions
Impressions	The number of times your page appeared in search results
Rich results	Results with extras such as stars, prices, images or event dates
CMS	Content management system: software to build and edit a website (WordPress, Wix, Shopify)

Term	Meaning
hreflang	A tag linking language versions of a page (e.g. English and French)
BRN	Business Registration Number, issued in Mauritius when a business is registered
Zero-click search	A search answered on the results page, with no click to a website

SECTION 16

Homework: your SEO Action Plan

Choose one real Mauritian business. Complete this plan (2 to 3 pages) and upload it to the learning platform before next week's session.

Part	Your answer
1. The business Name, type, location, website and social pages	
2. Who searches for it? Locals, tourists or both? Which languages?	
3. 15 keywords With intent (know / go / local / do-buy) and the page each one belongs to	
4. Google results check Search the 3 main keywords on google.mu: ads? map? AI Overview? who ranks?	
5. Google Business Profile audit 5 things missing or to improve	
6. Website quick check Mobile, speed score, titles and descriptions of 3 pages, Search Console?	
7. Reviews & links Review count and rating; 3 sites that could link to it	
8. AI visibility test Ask 3 customer questions in ChatGPT and Google AI Mode: is the business mentioned? Who is?	
9. 30-day action plan 8 to 10 actions, who does them, by when	
10. How you will measure Which numbers, where, how often	

Need help? Ask during the next session or contact your trainers: digitalmarketer@hseniva.com. The learning platform has this guide, the slides and the quiz for this module.